Friends of the Mihai Eminescu Trust Newsletter

December 2015

We wish you all a very Happy Christmas

The Trust has been hard at work since so many of us met last April in Thomas Gibson's wonderful garden at Westwell. Thanks to the generosity and support of all our FRIENDS, the Richis house restoration has progressed ten-fold over the summer and autumn. The same is also the case with the fortified church and its precincts in Alma Vii.

Come and visit Transylvania in 2016 to see these projects as they near completion, you can stay in a MET guest-house (see: Experience Transylvania). For those who love riding, Rachel and James de Candole have bought a manor and stables in nearby Copsa Mare. They will provide well-schooled horses with comfortable English saddles for you to ride through the villages, hills and woods (email: james.decandole@outlook.com).

For those who love history and literature, come to the second Transylvanian Book Festival next September. The 3 days will focus on the fall of the Austro-Hungarian and the Ottoman Empires, events in Central Europe after 1918, with historians Norman Stone, Bernard Wasserstein and other outstanding speakers, musicians and poets.

RICHIS HOUSE PROJECT

Following the success of the Apafi Manor in Mălâncrav, the Trust has been restoring the ruined house in the heart of Richis village. Although smaller in scale than the Apafi project, the aims are similar. The house will provide accommodation for 9. Once again David Mlinaric has generously given his time and advice on the interior. There will again be a library, a music room, and 5 beautiful bedrooms, all with ceramic stoves.











ALMA VII CHURCH RESTORATION



Work started in March on restoring the magnificent Saxon church fortification in Alma Vii. In competition with 200 applicants, the Mihai Eminescu Trust, partnered by EEA Grants, the Norwegian Institute for Cultural Heritage Research, and with indispensable help from Richard Oldfield, was awarded the €1.7 million contract.





During the summer and autumn, work was finished on the drainage, on the outside walls, and on the inner balcony. Completion is imminent on the museum, as well as on the four towers, whose roofs have been restored using traditional joints and handmade tiles and the walls consolidated and plastered using lime mortar. Inside the towers there will be 21 new exhibition rooms.

Becoming a Friend of the MET

If you are not already a Friend of the trust, or would like to introduce someone, please go to the Friends page on our website:

Friends - Supporting the Trust

I look forward to being in touch again in the New Year with more reports on our work, and our new projects for 2016.

Jessica Douglas-Home

The Mihai Eminescu Trust
www.mihaieminescutrust.org